



**ONCE UPON A
GRAND OLD TIME:**
(Above) A silver
coach used by former
maharajas now
stands in the darbar
hall of Patiala's Qila
Mubarak, whose
15-metre-high
ceiling is inlaid
with plaster-of-paris
tiles painted in
Arabic style

**SNAPSHOT
SOIREE:**

(Right) A view of
the Taj Mahal and
its reflection in
the Yamuna at
dawn from across
the river; (below)
the ceremonial
umbrellas of
Udaipur's Royal
Cenotaphs, built
to honour the
maharanas who
have ruled the
city since 1559

